

Improving Zomato Ratings and Reviews

Improving the reviews and ratings of the Zomato Food Delivery App

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Status: In Development

Launching on: 20/02/2025

Resources: Link to previous PRDs etc

Problem Definition

- What is the problem?

Customers do not visit the review or rating page

- They think there is no value addition from writing reviews
- Time consuming process to write a review
- There is no incentive in writing a review
- Who is facing the problem?
 - Customers who do not write a review or visit review page
- What is the business value that will be unlocked by solving the problem?
 - Search engine optimization for items thus increasing organic traffic
 - Cost reduction - As customer makes more informed decision, It is highly unlikely that he will cancel the order now.
 - Better Customer Engagement - This is done via more reviews will have better decision making for the customers.
- How will the target users benefit if the problem is solved?
 - They can make informed decision based on the reviews
 - More options to choose from if higher reviews present
- Why is it urgent to solve this problem now?
 - The business impact is huge, Increasing the non-reviewers to reviewers by 2% will increase the reviews by 14%
 - Reviews will help us to retain users based on better user experience and will give us better engagement

Goals

Describe the high-level goals and ideally in priority order.

- List out the measurable metrics (functional and non-functional) here

Functional Metrics

Why are these metrics important?

The below metrics measure the activation of a user by becoming a reviewer or becoming a reviewer. They help us to determine if we are moving towards the goal of increasing the overall reviews on the platform.

- Customers
 - % Reviewers per day/week/month
 - % New Reviewers
 - Retention rate
 - 7/30 order retention rate
 - Churn rate (No reviews in last 6 Months)
 - Activation rate (Atleast 1 review after ordering from Zomato)
 - Failure Metric (This helps us determine if the new feature that we have introduced does not affect our existing active users and ratings)
 - Churn rate (No orders in last 6 Months)
 - Ratings rate (No of Ratings/No of Orders)
- The below metrics measure the engagement of a user by getting involves in the process of writing a review. They help us to determine if we are efficient in making the users write a review or increase the reviews they write.
 - Average review writing time
 - No of reviews per reviewer
 - No of Orders reviewed per reviewer
 - No of Items reviewed per Order
 - Review Completion Rate
 - No of reviews completed
 - No of review writing page visited
 - Failure Metric (This help us to determine if we are not reducing the time spent for analysing, browsing menu for users if review writing time gets increased)
 - App Usage time (decreased due to more review writing time)
 - Order engagement time
- The below metrics measure the awareness of a user if they ever visit the reviews page. They help us to determine the potential users who could write a review
 - Visiting rate
 - Ratings page visited
 - No of Ratings notifications showed
 - No of Ratings notifications clicked
 - Reviews page visited

Non-Functional Metrics

The below metrics measure how the platform is performing. If users are facing any problems with respect to the feature

Review page Load time

- Rating time load
- Text box load time

Review Memory Usage

- Photo Memory usage
- Text memory usage

Non-Goals

List out areas that you don't plan to address. Define the scope clearly.

- To calculate the amount of fake reviews
- To check the quality of the reviews
- This will not cater to those who are not gold subscribers
- This will not consider the segment who have written reviews atleast once

Validation of the problem

User Survey

- Mostly users think writing reviews takes a lot of time
- It would be easy if the reviews are in mcq type format
- Forgets to write a review
- There is no incentive in writing the review
- People review on apps where the order was too good or too bad

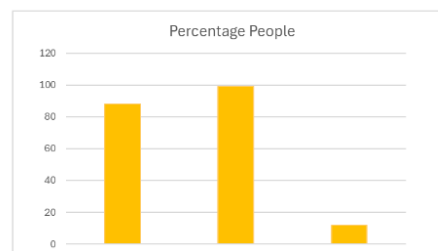
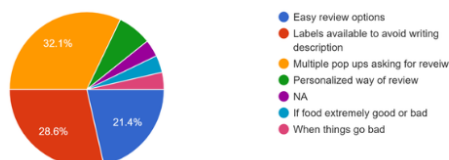
What is the reason that prompts you to review on the food delivery app ?
32 responses



What is the reason that you do not write a reviews ?
34 responses



What prompts you to write a review on those apps ?
28 responses



Understanding the target audience

Help the reader empathise with the target audience.

- The user segment we are targeting here is non-reviewers who are gold users (79.2M)

Type of Reviewer	% Split	Gold %	# Review per reviewer (Per Year)	Increased to	Increased reviews in a year
Casual	0.4	12	2	2	2112
Power	0.1	12	5	2	3380
Rare	0.5	12	1	2	2112

Non-Reviewers	99	12	0	2% (converted to rare reviewers)	42000
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Key Personas



DESCRIPTION

Reena is a working professional who has just began her professional journey. She is aged 25.

PERSONAL CHARACTERISTICS

- Prepares own food
- Lives Alone
- Independent

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

- Recharging
- Shopping
- Plays Badminton

BUYING ROLES

Buyer

GOALS

- To order food when there is some craving
- To order food when there is nothing at home
- To order when she did not like to cook

CHALLENGES

- Too busy for elaborate text reviews
- Forgets to write a review

BUYER'S JOURNEY

(Login, Search, Order, Delivery)

NEEDS

- Easy label based or description based answers to click
- Needs to have a reminder for reviews

SOURCES OF INFO

- News
- Social Media
- Peers

Reena

Age: 25
Location: Pune
Occupation: Data Engineer
Level: IC



DESCRIPTION

Rupesh is a working professional who is middle aged. He prefers to eat out and go and experience places to try out variety of food.

PERSONAL CHARACTERISTICS

- Prepares only when maid is not present
- Lives with flatmates
- Independent

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

- Busy in personal work
- Travels
- Plays Sport

BUYING ROLES

Buyer

GOALS

- To go out and eat when there is craving
- To order food for friends and families
- To order in rare scenarios when there is no option available

CHALLENGES

- Orders food for others & not aware about the food quality
- Forgets to write a review as the food is rated after consumption

BUYER'S JOURNEY

(Login, Search, Order, Add address, Delivery)

NEEDS

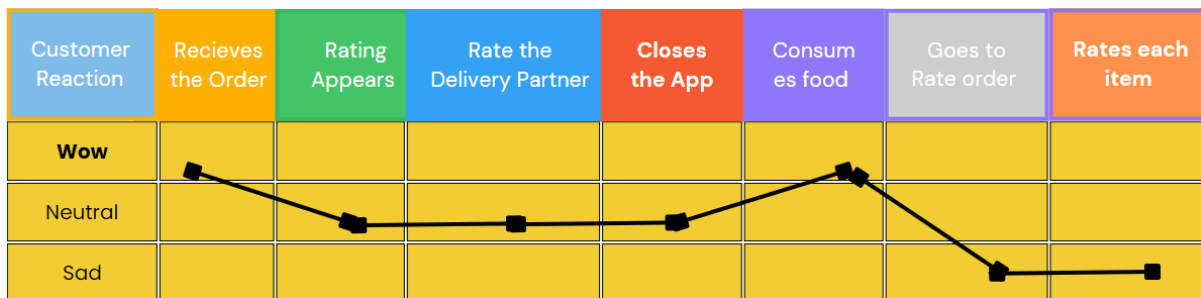
- Reminders to write a review
- Easy to find ratings and reviews tab

SOURCES OF INFO

- News
- Social Media
- Peers

Rupesh

Age: 28
Location: Pune
Occupation: Working Professional



- Talk about their unmet needs (goals and pain points)

Pain Points

- Users are looking at easy review writing system, as they might need to think a lot while writing descriptive text reviews.
- They don't see a value in writing a review as the impact of it is not seen directly though they agree that the reviews are helpful to order.

Goal

- The goal of the user is to get satisfaction by displaying his/her emotions towards the food
- The goal of the user is to display these emotions as efficiently as possible with less effort

Solution

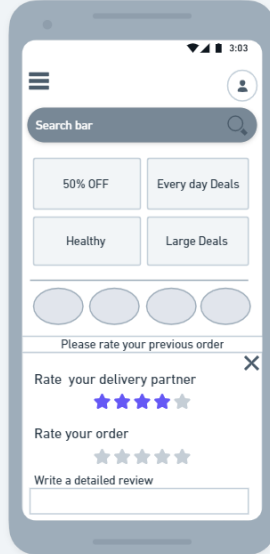
The solution is to take the user to the review page as from the survey and interviews it was found they never visited the review page as they think it is a time-consuming process. Also, along with that we need to modify the review based on labels and descriptive keywords for easy review writing. Once they write the reviews and finds the process efficient, they might be willing to write more reviews (retain them).

This can be done

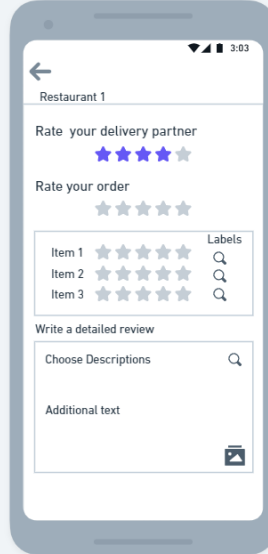
1. Either providing notification after half an hour or after an hour of the order is received.
 2. Or popping up the review screen the next time they will order something
- **Key Features:** the user benefits that will be developed
 - Remind the users to rate on optimal basis
 - Take them to the review page by in app notifications or pop ups
 - Include labels to review like in dining review
 - **Key Logic:** algorithm changes, schema changes, new data types etc.
 - Algorithm change will be just for additional notifications after half an hour of the order is received
 - And Pop ups whenever the next order is placed
 - Varchar Data types would be required for labels and descriptive keywords
 - **User Flows/wireframes/mockups**

Rating When opening the app for next order

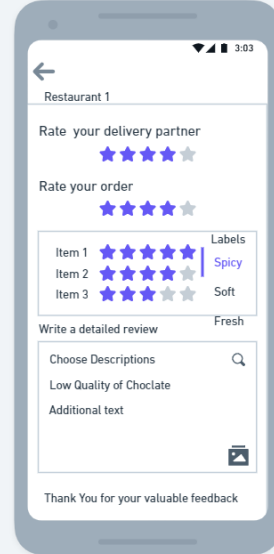
Opens the app for next order



Go to Ratings Screen

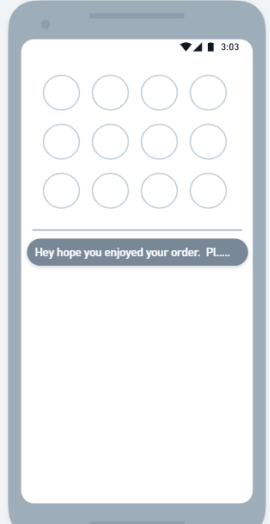


Complete ratings

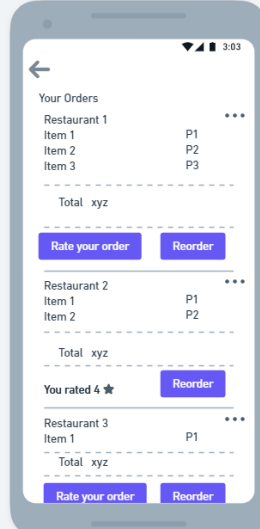


Rating When opening the app from notification

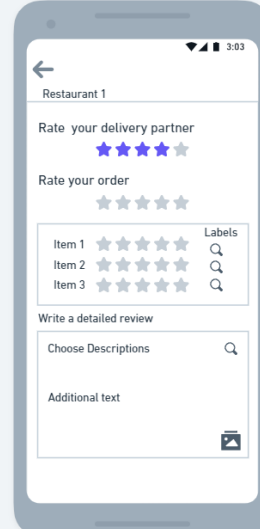
Notification bar



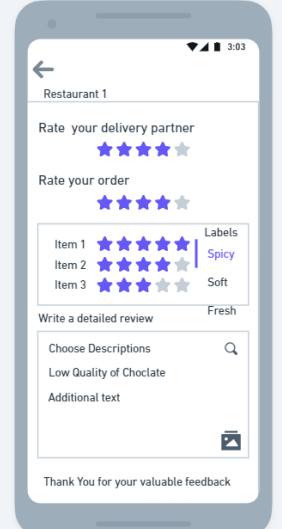
Go to Orders Screen



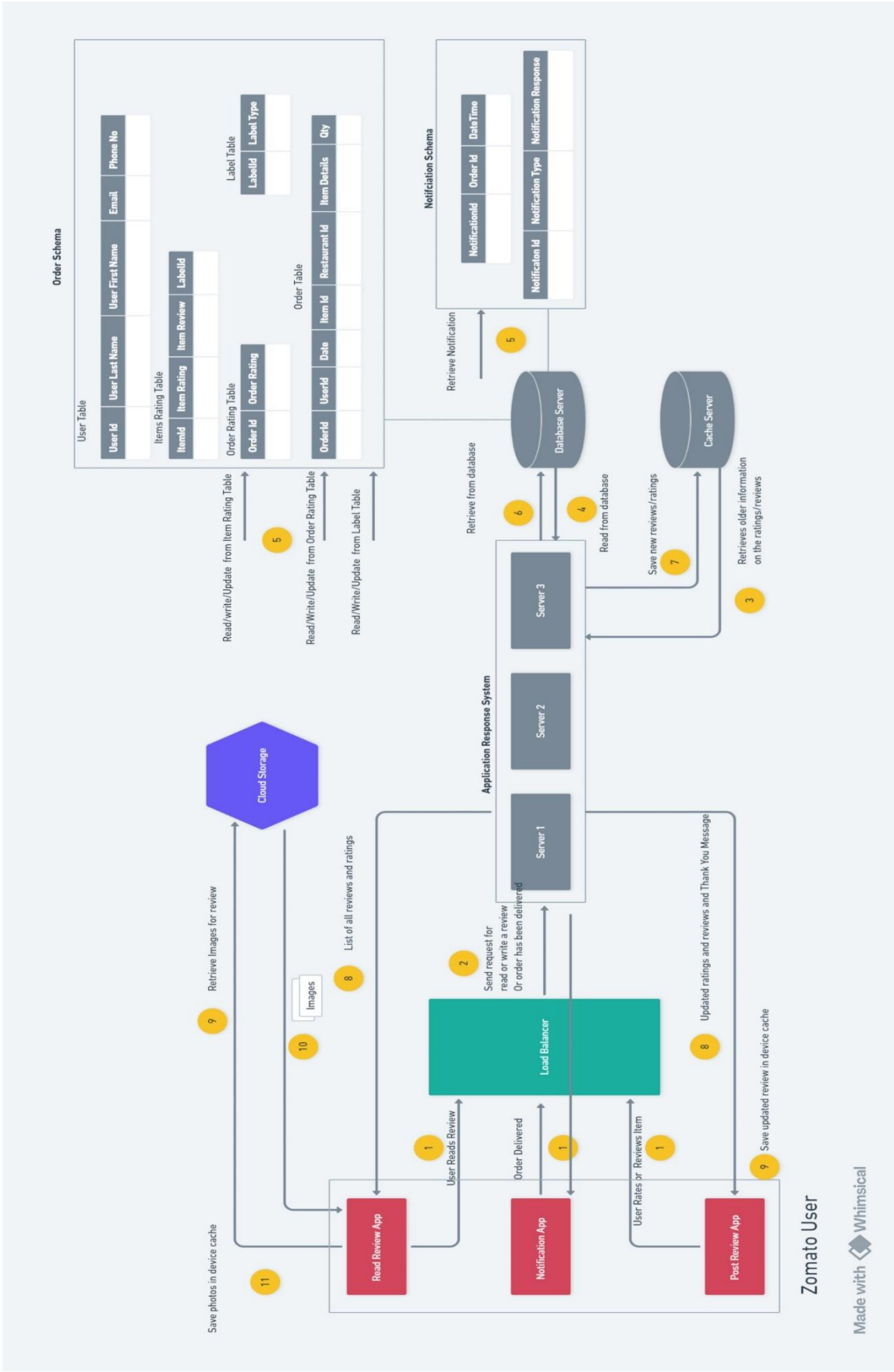
Go to Ratings Screen



Complete ratings



System Diagram



Product Marketing

- **Company Blogs:** We will publish a blog post with complete details on new feature and how it helped the user experience to be enhanced. This blog will have all the details along with the associated screenshots of the new feature.
- **In App Callouts:** In the app, while the user goes to review page, we will show a prompt while the page loads up about the new feature of label and descriptions as well as there will be tips and tricks to use it in a better way.
- There will be a joke or information on the prompt page on the new feature for user to try it out. This prompt will keep the users engaged of what next is to uncover.

Data Instrumentation Diagram for a Review System

1. User Interaction Layer:

- **Review Submission:** Users submit reviews (text, rating, images) through the app/website.
- **Upvotes/Downvotes:** Users can upvote or downvote reviews.
- **Commenting:** Users can comment on existing reviews.

2. Event Tracking & Logging:

Review Submission Event: Captures the event when a user submits a review.

- **Vote Event:** Captures when a user upvotes or downvotes a review.
- **Comment Event:** Captures when a user adds a comment to a review.
- **User Metadata:** Collects metadata such as user ID, location, and device information during these events.

3. Data Collection Layer:

- **Event Loggers:** Each event (submission, vote, comment) is logged into a centralized logging system.
- **Metrics Collection:** Collects quantitative data (e.g., number of reviews, average rating).
- **Database Storage:** All reviews, votes, and comments are stored in a database.

4. Processing & Analysis Layer:

- **Data Processing Pipeline:** Processes raw event data, cleans it, and transforms it into structured data.
- **Sentiment Analysis:** Analyzes the sentiment of the text in reviews to categorize them as positive, neutral, or negative.

- **Spam Detection:** Filters out fake or spammy reviews using machine learning algorithms.
- **Trend Analysis:** Identifies trends in reviews, such as common keywords or issues.

5. **Monitoring & Alerting Layer:**

- **Real-time Monitoring:** Continuously monitors the review system for anomalies (e.g., sudden spike in negative reviews).
- **Alerts:** Generates alerts for administrators if suspicious activity is detected (e.g., mass fake reviews).

6. **Data Aggregation & Visualization Layer:**

- **Dashboards:** Visualizes key metrics such as the number of reviews, average rating, sentiment distribution, and top-reviewed items.
- **Reports:** Generates reports on review trends, user engagement, and system performance.
- **User Feedback:** Collects and visualizes feedback on the review system itself (e.g., ease of use, accuracy).

7. **Integration Layer:**

- **API Integration:** Allows other services (e.g., recommendation systems, customer support) to access review data.
- **Third-Party Analytics:** Sends data to third-party analytics tools for further analysis and insights.

8. **Compliance & Security Layer:**

- **Data Anonymization:** Ensures user data is anonymized where necessary to comply with privacy regulations.
- **Secure Storage:** Protects sensitive user data using encryption and secure access controls.

Key Features: The user benefits that will be developed

- Remind the users to rate on an optimal basis
- Make them visit to the review page by in app notifications or pop ups
- Labels will be included to rate an item
- Descriptive answers would be provided for complete text review

Key Logic: algorithm changes, schema changes, new data types etc.

- Algorithm change will be just for additional notifications after half an hour of the order is received
- And a pop up for review whenever the next order is placed after the current order
- Varchar Data types would be required for labels and descriptive keywords
- In the schema labelId and label name table would be required, Similarly for description it would be description name and description Id.

Launch Readiness

List out the steps leading up to the launch

- Key Milestones (design complete, development complete, QA timelines, dogfooding)

Design

- Creating User Stories
- Writing Acceptance Criterion
- Adding Technical Requirements

Solution Designing

- Prototyping and
- Usability Testing

Development

- Architecture design
- Breaking down of tasks
- Sprint Planning
- Front end development
- Backend development
- Integration
- Continuous Testing

Quality Assurance

- Manual Testing
- Automated Testing
- Performance Testing

- Security Testing

Review and feedback

- Code Reviews
- Stakeholder reviews
- User Acceptance review

Deployment

- Pre-Deployment Testing
- Deployment
- Monitoring

- **Launch Checklist** (answer questions that your stakeholders might have around support, operations, etc). Identify all internal stakeholders
 - **Sales and Customer Support Training:** Train internal teams on product features, benefits, and how to handle customer inquiries.
 - **Product Readiness:** Ensure the product is fully developed, tested, and ready for launch. This includes finalizing packaging and distribution channels.
 - **Content Creation:** Develop marketing materials such as landing pages, press releases, social media content, and advertisements.

Future iterations

Talk about the potential iterations to the feature

Scope of next versions

- Next Iteration of product will have more gamification featured labels such as fire for sizzling, spicy food or reaction-based approach with labels
- Next iteration will create summary of reviews for a dish based on the historical reviews

Ideas which were parked for later

- Autocomplete the statement via AI
- Multiple choice answers based on previous and predicted text reviews
- Identify and notify at idle time of users to review

The rollout would be done in batches

We will first test the feature on the loyal customer base of users, once we see a good adoption rate among these Users, we will share it in phases across other users as well.

Risks & Mitigations

Brainstorm things that can go wrong and how you plan to avoid them

- By adding multiple notification, the users may get pissed off and switch to other platforms or write incorrect ratings/reviews

Mitigation - User are allowed to select the notification in settings for order, they can switch of notification or a pop up can show up if the notification system is not liked by them.

- As the notification is sent after half an hour, it might happen the user is yet to consume food or have already consumed it.

- The food was ordered for someone else, so the user might not be eligible for review

Mitigation - Provide dismiss or do it later option.

- Biasness in User Testing

Mitigation - Carry out user testing for a random set of Peoples

- Similar kind of labels selected in most of the reviews or incorrect labelization

Mitigation - Refine the lables and suggestion based on the item ordered

- The user survey revealed that people do not visit the page for review due to time taking format of review, or they forget to write a review, or they do not have enough incentive to write one. Based on the data points, we have included the first two part and made the review process easier but if over the wide spectrum of people if the major reason is people do not have enough incentive then this review system is bound to fail.

Mitigation - Roll out the feature or batches of people and understand if the feature is working for them based on the metrics used, else iterate on the idea and dig deeper.

- Users are not able to understand how to use the new feature

Mitigation - Users are provided with proper tooltips or explanatory videos will be created for ease and better understanding.

Open Questions & Decisions Taken

Keep a note of all the open questions and document the decisions being taken at each step of the review process.

1. What if your hypothesis fails? There is no significant improve in user engagement.
 2. The marketing plan is insufficient to aware the customers, so how do we engage them in that case?
 3. Why was this not implemented in Delivery if it was already present for dining?
 4. Is there a timeline that we are thinking this feature will start showing business impact?
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- Outline what has been descoped
 - Checking Quality of reviews
 - Spam review detection
 - Short Mcq questions instead of the labels

 - List out the trade-offs made
 - System Architecture would have to be changed to incorporate the other solutions , So it was easier to go with the current solution
 - Since labels and description consume some space in the review space, The storage capacity needs to be increased as part of the solution.
 - Fetching labels and creating descriptive tabs will require generating them based on the historical data. Hence the computational cost for ML algorithms implementation would also increase

References

- <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/tech/startups/online-food-delivery-market-to-grow-18-on-year-to-rs-2-lakh-crore-by-2030-bain-report/articleshow/111452013.cms?from=mdr>
- <https://www.kenresearch.com/industry-reports/india-online-food-delivery-market>
- <https://blog.zomato.com/reviews-2-0>
- <https://www.zomato.com/investor-relations/financials>

Link for Resources

- Mind Map - <https://whimsical.com/increase-customer-reviews-Kcixq5SWrFWqhnYgj6v9dd>
- Workflows - <https://whimsical.com/zomato-review-93xAqiWSHjkNHwAdCf68WZ>
- System Design - <https://whimsical.com/system-diagram-zomato-reviews-H1m8eHc76yPnszjb9cHd5d>
- KPI tree - https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVKvfhiUM=?share_link_id=282225120026
- Google forms - https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1srRoJlg3pbccuNZlvgTEh0yME_ueXask1hW2ZoRCFYM/edit